



# **IKS – INDIAN KNOWLEDGE SYSTEMS**

## **UNIT 2 - YOGA BASIC PRACTICES AND PHILOSOPHY**

**LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR**

**18<sup>th</sup> August, 2025**

# SCOPE OF STUDY

## UNIT 2.1

1. Maharshi Patanjali
2. Swami Satyananada Sarawati
3. B.K.S. Iyengar
- 4. Swami Kuvalayananda**
- 5. Shri Yogendra**

## UNIT 2.2

1. Body loosening exercises
2. Importance of breath
3. Developing concentration
4. Yoga for mind – body wellness



# **SWAMI KUVALYANANDA**

**LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR**

**18<sup>th</sup> August, 2025**

# SHANTI PRAYER

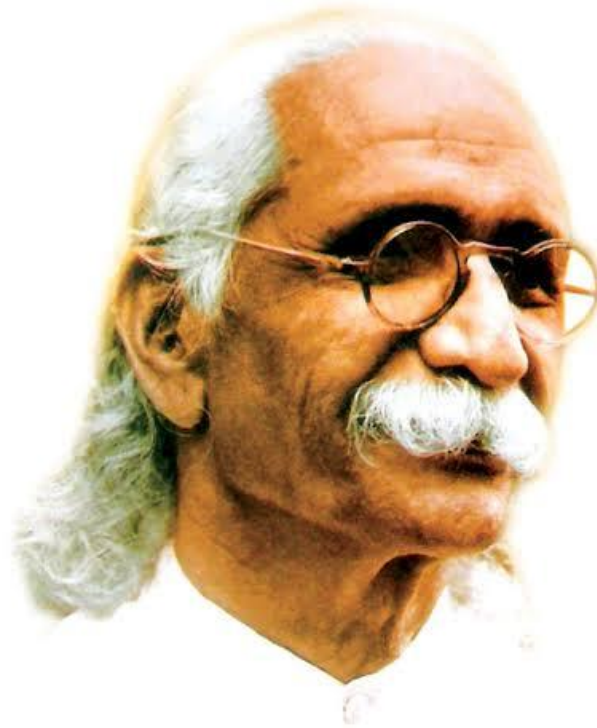
Krishna Yajurveda Taittiriya Upanishad (2.2.2)

ॐ सहनाववतु  
सह नौ भुनक्तु  
सह वीर्यं करवाव है  
तेजस्वि नावधीतमस्तु मा विद्विषाव है  
ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

Om̐ Saha nāvavatu  
Saha nau bhunaktu  
Saha vīryam karavāvahai  
Tejasvi nāvadhītamastu  
Mā vidviṣāvahai  
Om̐ Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ

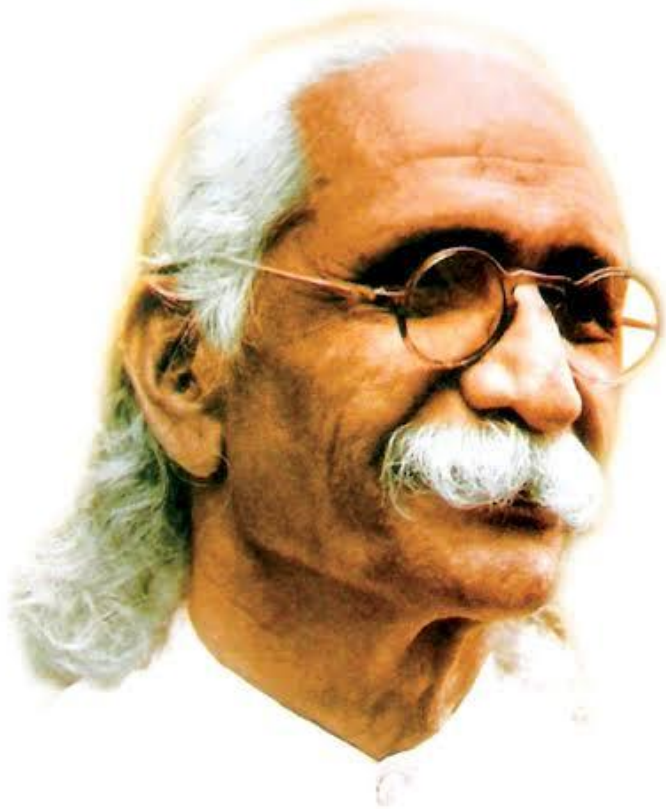
Om, May we all (Teacher and student) be protected  
May we all be nourished  
May we work together with great energy  
May our intellect be sharpened (may our study be effective) ; Let there be no Animosity amongst us  
Om, peace, peace, peace

# **SWAMI KUVALYANANDA**



**FOUNDER : KAIVALYADHAMA YOGA INSTITUTE**

# SWAMI KUVALAYANANDA



- Born: 30 August 1883, in Dhule, Maharashtra, India
- Died: 18 April, 1966, in Lonavala, Maharashtra at the age of 82 years
- Known as Founder of Kaivalyadham
- Famous for bridging traditional Yoga with Modern Science
- A Yoga researcher, educationist, nationalist and reformer

# EARLY LIFE

- Swami Kuvalyananda was born on 30 August 1883 as Jagannatha Ganesha Gune in a modest family
- He was raised with a strong sense of discipline, national idealism and patriotic fervor
- This prompted him to devote his life to the service of humanity.
- He excelled academically and graduated from Baroda College under the able mentorship of Gopal krishna Gokhale

# EARLY LIFE

- During his student days, he was influenced by political leaders like Sri Aurobindo and Lokmanya Tilak's Indian Home Rule Movement
- He realised the value of education after coming into contact with many illiterate and superstitious masses.
- He was thus influenced to help organize the Khandesh Education Society at Amalner,
- Here in 1916 he became the Principal of the National College



# INITIATION IN YOGA

- Swamiji's first guru was Rajaratna Manikrao, a professor at the Jummada Vyayamshala in Baroda.
- From 1907 to 1910, Manikrao trained Kuvalayananda in the Indian System of Physical Education
- In 1919, he met the Bengali yogin, Paramahansa Madhavdasji, who blessed Swamiji with insights into advanced yogic discipline
- Swamiji was spiritually inclined and idealistic but at the same time he was a strict rationalist.
- He sought scientific explanations for the various psycho-physical effects of Yoga which he experienced.

# SCIENTIFIC BASIS OF YOGA

- Swami Kuvalayananda's life's goal was to discover the scientific basis behind yogic processes
- In 1924, the Kaivalyadhama Health and Yoga Research Center in Lonavla was founded by Swamiji to provide a laboratory for his scientific study of Yoga and its effects on the body and mind.
- Kaivalyadhama was the first Yoga Institute of its kind established in 1924 in Lonavala, Maharashtra
- It continues to be a premier center for the medical and scientific study of Hatha Yoga
- As well as a resource of ancient texts, teachings, training and yoga therapy.

# KAIVALYADHAM, LONAVLA



# SPREADING OF YOGA

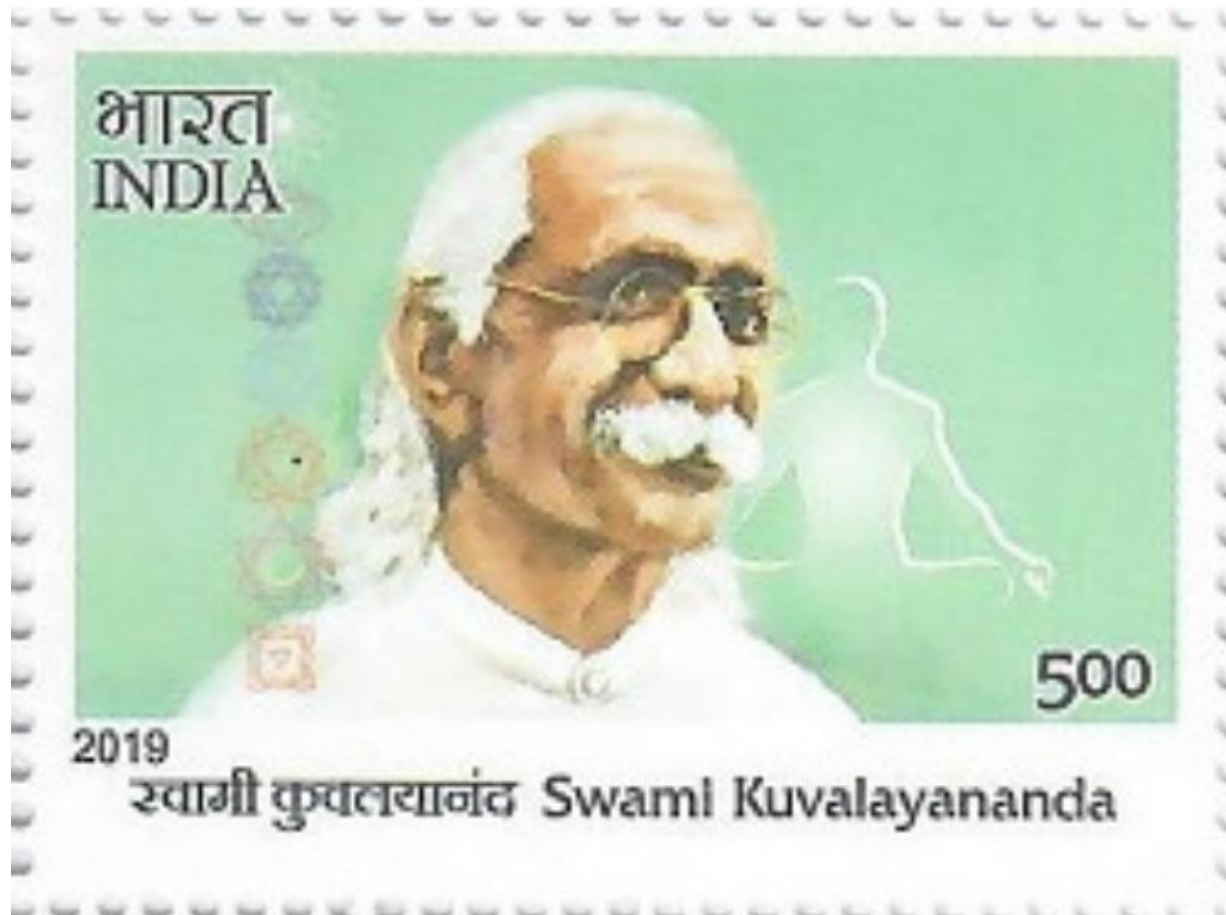
- Swamiji also started in 1924 the first scientific journal devoted to scientific investigation into yoga, Yoga Mimamsa
- The main Kaivalyadhama campus in Lonavala was also enhanced with the College of Yoga and a Yogic hospital.
- Kaivalyadham has two departments –
- Scientific Research - to study yoga through Biology, Physiology, and Psychology
- Philosophico-Literary – to preserve and translate ancient Yogic texts
- Kaivalyadhama is instrumental in publishing many books on Yoga (e.g. Patanjala Yoga Sutras, Asanas, Pranayama, Hatha Yoga, Yogic therapy, etc.)

# GROWTH OF YOGA

- In addition to research into yogic practices, Swamiji spent much of his later years opening up new branches of Kaivalyadhama in Mumbai and Rajkot
- Swamiji taught Yoga to eminent personalities of that time (Pandit Jawarharlal Nehru, Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya) which helped popularise Yoga. It is visited by Mahatma Gandhi, Rajendra Prasad and Indira Gandhi
- His motto- “Yoga is not a religion, it is a science of living”
- Recognising Swamiji’s pioneering work in the field of yoga a commemorative postage stamp honouring Swami Kuvalayananda was released by the Indian Postal Department on August 30, 2019 as part of the "Master Healers of AYUSH" series



# HONORING SWAMI KUALAYANANDA



# MAHASAMADHI

- Swami Kuvalayananda took samadhi on 18 April, 1966. The Samadhi Sthala of Swami Kuvalayananda is located within Kaivalyadhama, Lonavala



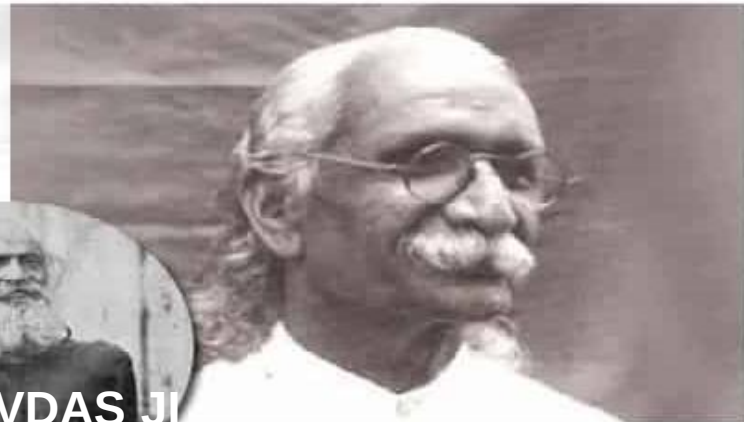
# FROM THE ARCHIVES

**BEGINNING OF  
KAIVALYADHAM**



**GURU MADHAVDAS JI**

**IN LATER LIFE**



**DEMONSTRATION TO  
NEHRUJI**



**IN YOUTH**



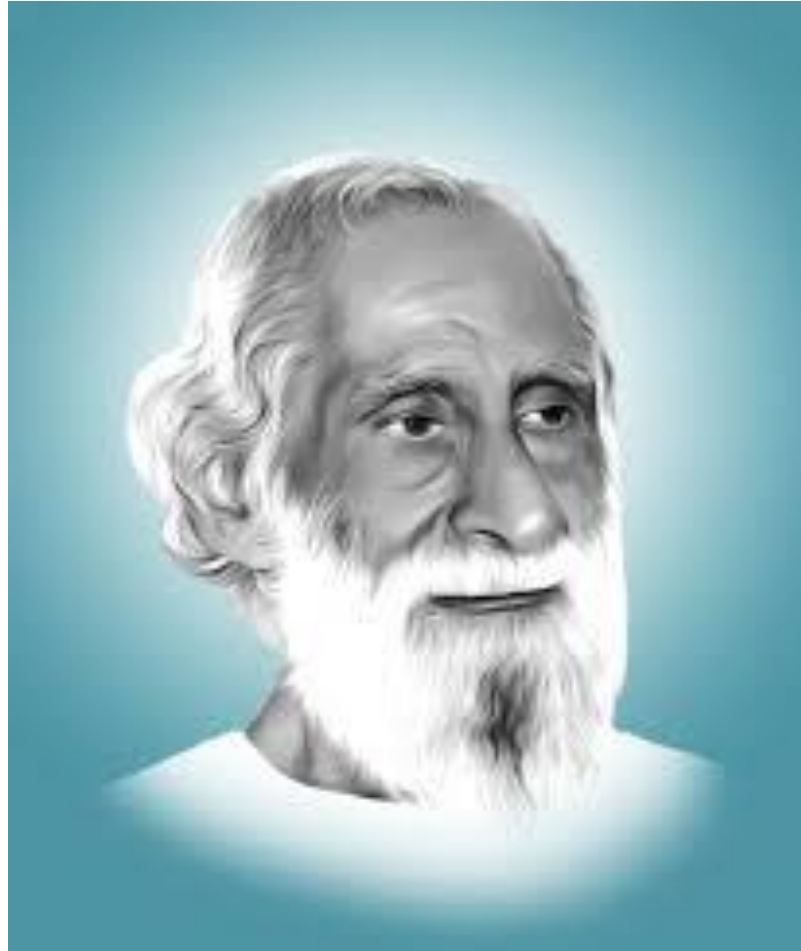


# **SHRI YOGENDRA**

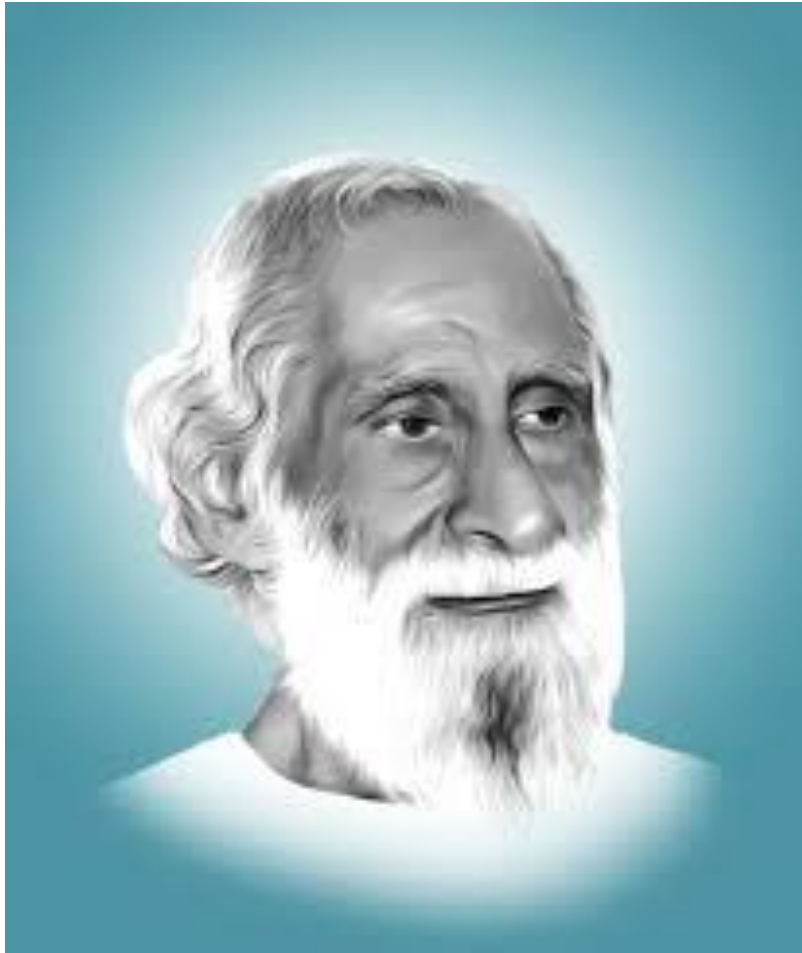
**LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR**

**18<sup>th</sup> August, 2025**

# SHRI YOGENDRA



# SHRI YOGENDRA



- Born: 18 November 1897 in Gujrat, India
- Died: 29 February 1989 in Mumbai, at the age of 91 years
- Known as Founder of The Yoga Institute, Santacruz
- Famous for developing Yoga for Householders
- Introduced innovative methods of teaching Ashtanga Yoga – based on mind control

# EARLY LIFE

- Shri Yogendra was born as Manibhai Haribhai Desai on 18 November 1897 in a village near Surat, Gujarat.
- He was brought up in a traditional Gujarati family with deep cultural roots and affectionately called Mogha ("priceless one") in his childhood.
- He was inclined towards self-discipline, spirituality and exploration of India's Ancient Heritage from an early age
- In 1916, at the age of eighteen he distinguished himself in the Amalsad English School and then went to attend St. Xavier's College in Bombay.
- In Bombay he felt homesick, lost his interest in studies and went into depression. As a cure his friend suggested that he visit the Dharamshala of Paramahansa Madhavadasaji at Madhav Baug

# INITIATION IN YOGA

- In late August 1916, Yogendra visited the Dharamshala of Paramahansa Madhavadasaji (a 119 year old yogi) at Madhav Baug
- Although he had a suspicion of sannyasis and sadhus his misgivings on sadhus disappeared after meeting with Paramahansa Madhavadasaji.
- In late 1916 Yogendra left his college and joined Madhavadasaji's Ashram in Malsar near Vadodara
- Paramahansa Madhavadasaji, was equally struck by Yogendra's qualities as a capable disciple.
- He followed yogic discipline, service and received special attention. It was clear that he was being educated and groomed to be Madhavadasaji's successor

# BASIS FOR YOGA TEACHING

- Yogendra learned Yoga, and much of the teaching was on the practical and pragmatic use of Yoga and its application in sickness and suffering.
- His training in Madhavadasaji Ashram was centered around yogic 'natural health cures' administered to patients in the ashram's sick ward
- Yogendra left the Ashram after more than two years life's work was to discover the scientific basis behind yogic processes
- His aim was to propagate yoga as a means of conscious evolution of the yoga students through applied science or the use of yogic practices to bring an improvement at the genetic level

# GROWTH OF YOGA

- At the age of 21 Shri Yogendra founded The Yoga Institute in 1918 by at the residence of Dadabhai Naoroji, at Versova beach near Bombay.
- It was later shifted and moved to Santacruz, in Bombay
- The aim of the Institute was to bring yoga asanas and yogic technologies to the common householder.
- It was the first organised Yoga center focusing on householder yoga i.e. making yoga accessible to everyday people (men, women and children) and not for just monks or ascetics
- Shri Yogendra's approach was scientific, practical, and secular i.e. integrating yoga into daily life for physical, mental, and spiritual well-being



# YOGA INSTITUTE, MUMBAI



# SPREADING THE MESSAGE OF YOGA

- In 1919, Shri Yogendra founded The Yoga Institute of America, New York
- In his US tours Shri Yogendra met Benedict Lust, one of the founders of naturopathic medicine, who saw the value of Hatha Yoga for his work.
- Shri Yogendra stayed with him and worked with a number of doctors advocating innovative treatment for diseases
- The work of Shri Yogendra attracted attention from doctors, scientists, and psychologists
- Shri Yogendra emphasized therapeutic yoga and scientific research and began the process of "domesticating" hatha yoga for its health benefits. This helped to undo the negative image of yoga and asana practice

# SPREADING THE MESSAGE OF YOGA

- Shri Yogendra toured the world, teaching yoga until his marriage to Seeta Devi in 1927.
- Yoga Institute has now branches in 12 countries
- In 1933 the first journal of The Yoga Institute, named YOGA was published.
- The journal has been renamed as Yoga & Total Health
- Shri Yogendra authored over 50 books on yoga, health, and philosophy.
- Some notable titles are :Yoga Personal Hygiene ; Yoga for Back and Joint Disorders; Yoga Explained; etc.

# LEGACY OF SHRI YOGENDRA

- Shri Yogendra was a visionary, reformer, and spiritual pioneer, who democratized yoga and planted its seeds across continents.
- His life was dedicated to uplifting humanity by restoring ancient wisdom to modern life — one breath, one posture, one person at a time
- Shri Yogendra advocated integrated yoga — combining all aspects of life: behavior, breath, thought, diet, discipline, and spiritual inquiry
- He believed in “Yoga in daily life” and emphasised on Yama and Niyamas
- His motto was “A better individual means a better world”

# LEGACY OF SHRI YOGENDRA

- Shri Yogendra died on 25 September 1989 at the age of 91 in Mumbai
- The Yoga Institute is recognized by the Ministry of AYUSH and UNESCO and it continues to thrive as a non-profit, educational and research-based yoga organization, now led by his family and senior teachers
- After his death the running of The Yoga Institute was taken over by his wife and then by his son Dr. Jayadeva Yogendra
- The Yoga Institute is currently run by Hansaji Yogendra the wife of Dr. Jayadeva Yogendra



# LINEAGE OF YOGA INSTITUTE



# HONOURING SHRI YOGENDRA CHOWK IN MUMBAI





**THANK YOU**